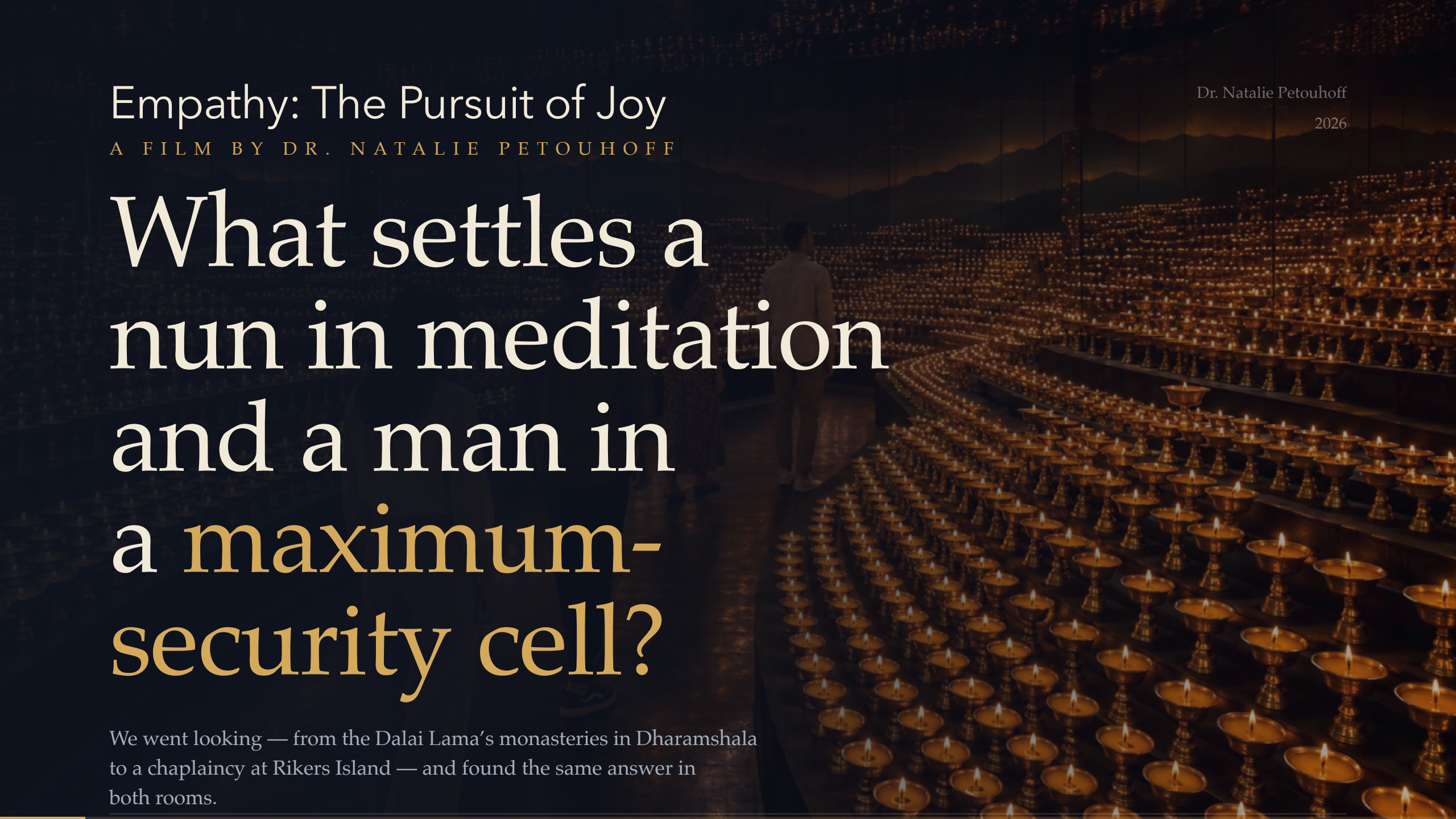




Empathy: The Pursuit of Joy

A FILM BY DR. NATALIE PETOUHOFF

Dr. Natalie Petouhoff

2026

What settles a nun in meditation and a man in a maximum- security cell?

We went looking — from the Dalai Lama's monasteries in Dharamshala to a chaplaincy at Rikers Island — and found the same answer in both rooms.

THE PROBLEM

The wise choice doesn't lose on merit. It loses at **the moment of need.**

The engineered fix

Stress, loneliness, numbness — and always within reach, a perfectly engineered fix: the scroll, the drink, the cart. Instant. Personalized. Frictionless. These aren't bad habits; they're the most sophisticated behavioral technology ever built — engineered for nervous systems that are already cornered.

The undelivered medicine

Contemplative practice wins the same moment, and has for three thousand years. It builds what the quick fixes only counterfeit: agency, meaning, connection. It just never got a delivery system.

Public translation.

The barrier isn't belief — it's translation. People don't reject this wisdom; they never receive it in a form their skepticism, their nervous system, or their worst moment can accept.

This project builds the translation layer between 3,000-year-old wisdom and a skeptical, pluralistic, overwhelmed modern audience — empathy as the method, science as the passport. Not a film about meditation. The delivery system the medicine never had.



The ancients had the insight.
What's new is *the instrument*.

Measurable regulation

Before/after neuroscience on real audiences:
watch it happen in your own body and brain.

Personalized feedback

The adoption lever the wellness industry
never had.

Format science

Testing what the nervous system will actually
accept: story, sound, rhythm, synchrony, breath.

This film could
not have been
made twenty years
ago. The wisdom
is ancient; *the
proof is brand new.*

A 90-minute feature and a series. A new category: therapeutic entertainment.

Real people — monks and maximum-security prisoners, doctors, artists, mothers, fathers — facing life's beautiful, brutal, in-between.

Every piece is both medicine and instrument: documentary segments, original score, breath-paced and binaural sound, contemplative visual art — built, measured, revised, tested. We don't make media and hope. We run a measured intervention with a film as its instrument.

THE WORK

A 90-minute feature **and** a series. A new category: therapeutic entertainment. — continued



THE WORK

A 90-minute feature **and** a series. A new category: therapeutic entertainment. — continued

▶ WATCH THE TRAILER

Assembled and already shooting.

Dr. Natalie Petouhoff

Bestselling author (Empathy in Action), story architect. The through-line: proving the soft thing can be measured — first for business, now for being human.

Josh Sikkema

Award-winning director — extreme technical craft with an emotionally intelligent lens.

Maejor

Grammy-nominated composer — mainstream music fused with ancient healing harmonics. Recording studio at the Dalai Lama's school.

THE TEAM

Assembled and **already shooting.** — continued



From production — the monk-and-scientist sessions

What survives a skeptical room.

Measured interventions

Before/after outcomes on self- and co-regulation, empathy, meaning, flourishing.

Case studies

Science-backed material that raises funding and validation for the whole field.

A peer-reviewed paper

Rare in this category — it converts a film into evidence.

Co-regulation focus

Loneliness is the wound; a room full of nervous systems settling together is the one thing the scroll can never offer.

The audience is already in the room.

A worldwide network — researchers, well-being organizations, practitioners, educators, artists, community leaders — is screening prototypes and shaping the work right now. They are our collaborators. When the film is ready, they are our distributors.

The audience is **already in the room.** — continued

The question every
producer fears
— “will anyone
watch?” — was
answered *before
a frame was shot.*

Event-based community screenings, curricula, and measured impact
outlive the release window.

Seven streams. One engine.

Screenings

Event-based, measured, community-hosted.

Curriculum

Licensing to schools, orgs, corporate well-being.

Sound-bath audio

Subscription soundtrack — binaural, breath-paced.

Immersive experience

Ticketed, Dataland-class installation.

Merch + fan funding

Zero-inventory commerce, community pre-commitment.

Book + paper

Authority engine feeding every other stream.



Three tiers. Each complete on its own.

1

PROOF

Finish the feature edit, complete the measurement round, festival + impact-screening run.

\$250–400K

2

TRANSLATION

+ scientifically-composed soundtrack, vertical content engine, series pilot package.

\$750K–1.2M

3

CATEGORY

+ series order package, immersive experience build, global screening + curriculum program.

\$2–3M

Four lanes open: grants (Templeton submitted) · equity · brand sponsorship · community funding. Final budget detail available under NDA.

Where the money **works**.

Make the work

Production completion — edit, score, sound design. Science — measurement rounds, analysis, publication. Translation engine — vertical content, formats testing.

Carry the work

Engagement — screenings, curriculum, network activation. Team — paying professionals their asking price. Detailed line budget under NDA on request.

THE SUMMONS

The film is a **reboot**. Join us.



“Not because I’m right
— but because of how
the human operating
system is designed.”

— Dr. Natalie Petouhoff

Empathy: The Pursuit of Joy · Ancient wisdom, proven by science · Our
journey — and now yours.